

Chapter 118-4

//

The next morning, when Liang Shi woke up, her embrace was already empty.

She touched the sheets—there was still some residual warmth.

Xu Qingzhu couldn't have gotten up long ago.

Liang Shi raised her arm to cover her eyes and lazed in bed for a while longer.

She turned on her side, burying her head in the pillow. Her breath was filled entirely with the fragrance of Xu Qingzhu's hair.

Liang Shi felt content, the corners of her mouth unconsciously turning up.

A dreamless night, her body extraordinarily relaxed.

After getting up, Liang Shi folded the blanket and walked out. Rainbow was already sitting at the dining table eating.

Liang Shi slapped her forehead and suddenly asked: "Rainbow, what time do you go to kindergarten?"

Rainbow replied obediently: "Jiejie, there's still plenty of time."

Liang Shi breathed a sigh of relief: "I thought you were going to be late. Go ahead and eat, I'll take you to school after you're done."

Rainbow responded with an "oh."

Meanwhile, Xu Qingzhu ate quietly.

This morning was no different from usual. After washing up, Liang Shi sat down at the dining table. Seeing it was purple rice porridge and buns bought from downstairs, she asked Xu Qingzhu: "What time did you get up?"

"Ten minutes before you," Xu Qingzhu said.

"And you already went downstairs to buy food that quickly?" Liang Shi was surprised.

Xu Qingzhu paused, her tone complicated: "Rainbow bought it."

Liang Shi: "....."

"Baby, how did you go downstairs to buy things by yourself?" Liang Shi was shocked, even her tone of speech different from usual. "Weren't you afraid of bad people?"

"It's just downstairs in the residential complex," Rainbow said. "I usually go down to buy things by myself too."

Liang Shi: "....."

She and Xu Qingzhu exchanged glances, both seeing disbelief in each other's eyes.

"It's still better not to," Liang Shi instructed her. "There are lots of cars outside now, and you're still a child. Just peacefully enjoy what the adults do for you."

Rainbow was silent for a moment, then said in a little-adult tone: "These are all small matters~"

Liang Shi didn't know what else to say.

As she ate the fruits of Rainbow's labor, she felt a bit guilty inside.

As an adult, she had actually lazed in bed until a five-year-old child had to run errands to buy breakfast—she really had no self-awareness.

Though last night had indeed been... somewhat tiring.

They hadn't done anything excessive, just she and Xu Qingzhu chatting—talking about Qi Jiao, about Chen Mian, about Yang Shuyan. They talked about so many people, and somehow somewhere they'd be touched and would get tangled up kissing.

.....

It had indeed been somewhat debauched.

When Liang Shi was washing up earlier, she had discovered that the corner of her mouth was broken.

She hadn't been willing to use force on Xu Qingzhu, so Xu Qingzhu had used force on her.

She ate breakfast with her mind wandering. Her thoughts had initially been on Rainbow buying breakfast, but before long they shifted to another matter, the scale so large that Liang Shi pinched her ears.

After breakfast, Liang Shi took Rainbow to kindergarten early.

Similar to when picking her up, the entrance was packed with people. Rainbow could walk a distance by herself, but Liang Shi still parked the car a bit further out and held her hand to the kindergarten entrance.

After she entered the school, Liang Shi lingered for a while before leaving.

As she was leaving, she saw Yang Jiani bringing Gu Xingyue to school. She hid in the crowd and watched for a few moments.

Yang Jiani was still wearing a qipao¹, moon-blue colored, with a jade bracelet on her arm, making her appear graceful and distinguished.

And Gu Xingyue was dressed similarly to yesterday. For her, after so many years, each day of her life was pretty much the same—this day was no different.

It seemed like time was moving forward, but in Gu Xingyue's world...

Yesterday, today, tomorrow were all the same.

Because Gu Xingyue was in darkness, and the one who had appeared now was Qi Jiao.

Liang Shi watched as Yang Jiani kept her eyes on Gu Xingyue until she entered the school, looked around, then left.

After that car drove away, Liang Shi was about to head to her own car when she spotted Cheng Ru smoking not far away.

Footnote:

¹ Qipao (旗袍): Also known as cheongsam, a traditional Chinese dress with a high collar and side slits, often made of silk or brocade. It's considered elegant and is associated with sophistication and cultural refinement.